

Rajesh Dammala

Senior Technical Program Manager — Cross-Functional Delivery, AI Product Execution & Executive Communication

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Greater Seattle, WA · On-site (5 days/week)
https://rdammala.github.io/PitchBook_Senior-Technical-Program-Manager/

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Technical Program Manager and delivery leader with 16+ years driving execution of complex, cross-functional software and platform programs across global teams. Combines operational rigor — disciplined planning, dependency mapping, risk management, and delivery predictability — with strong technical fluency in cloud architecture, system design, and AI/LLM product delivery (model evaluation frameworks; latency, cost, reliability, integration trade-offs). Serves as the bridge between engineering and executive leadership, building reporting frameworks and decision-ready written communications (status reports, executive briefs, decision memos, risk summaries). Known for bringing structure to ambiguity, influencing without authority, and a relentless bias for action.

CAREER SNAPSHOT

16+ Years in IT / Cloud / Reliability Engineering
100% SLA Across 20+ Mission-Critical Services
30-35% Incidents Auto-Resolved via AI Automation
25,000+ Stale Incidents Eliminated
85%!'98% Operational Efficiency Lift
15-32 Engineers Led Across Global Teams

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Drove end-to-end execution of a strategic AI automation program from concept through launch and scale across Product, Engineering, and Operations.
- Led cross-functional delivery of AI/LLM-powered capabilities reaching 30-35% auto-resolution, managing model evaluation and latency/cost/reliability trade-offs.
- Acted as the primary bridge between engineering and C-suite leadership with decision-ready briefs, status reports, and risk summaries.
- Built reporting frameworks (KQL + Power BI) that drove prioritization and maintained executive visibility into progress and risk.
- Brought structure to ambiguity — eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and sustained 100% SLA across 20+ services while coaching teams on planning discipline.
- Led and aligned cross-functional teams of 15-32 across the US and India through influence without authority.

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Program Management: Cross-Functional Execution, Roadmap & Dependency Management, Risk & Issue Management, Milestone & Delivery Planning, Scope/Schedule Trade-off Management, Delivery

Predictability

Methodologies & Tools: Agile / Scrum, SAFe, Kanban, Jira, Confluence, Azure DevOps, Power BI, Kusto (KQL)

AI / LLM Product Delivery: LLM-Powered Capabilities, Model Evaluation Frameworks, Latency / Cost / Reliability Trade-offs, AI Agent Infrastructure, Production Integration Complexity

Technical Fluency: Cloud Architecture (Azure / AWS), System Design Discussions, APIs & Integrations, CI/CD, Containers (Kubernetes/Docker), Data & Reporting Pipelines

Executive Communication: C-Suite & Steering Committee Facilitation, Decision Memos & Executive Briefs, Status & Risk Reporting, Influence Without Authority, Stakeholder Management

Scripting & Data: Python, PowerShell, SQL, Reporting Frameworks & Metrics

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

Cross-Functional Program Execution — **Expert**

Dependency & Risk Management — **Expert**

Executive / C-Suite Communication — **Expert**

AI/LLM Product Delivery & Evals — **Advanced**

Technical Fluency (Cloud / System Design) — **Advanced**

Reporting Frameworks & Data-Driven Decisions — **Advanced**

Agile / SAFe / Kanban Delivery — **Expert**

Stakeholder Management — **Expert**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Technical Program / Delivery Lead — Xbox Cloud Services

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra) | Redmond, WA | May 2021 - Present

Drives end-to-end execution of a high-impact AI automation initiative across Product, Engineering, and Operations for a 24/7/365 platform serving millions of users.

- Drove end-to-end execution of a strategic, cross-functional AI incident-automation program from early concept through launch and scale, aligning Product, Engineering, Design, and Operations to clear goals, milestones, and success metrics.
- Led cross-functional delivery of AI-powered product capabilities (Azure SRE Agent) reaching 30-35% auto-resolution; managed LLM model-evaluation frameworks and production trade-offs across latency, cost, reliability, and integration complexity.
- Translated technical strategy into structured execution plans — defining deliverables, sequencing, resource needs, and measurable business outcomes — while mapping system, roadmap, and integration dependencies across interconnected teams.
- Served as the primary communication bridge between engineering teams and executive leadership, distilling program status, risks, and decisions into decision-ready briefs, status reports, and risk summaries for C-suite stakeholders.
- Proactively surfaced execution risks early, challenged misaligned assumptions, clarified scope/schedule trade-offs, and presented solution paths that enabled timely, well-informed leadership decisions.
- Built reporting frameworks (Kusto/KQL + Power BI) that used data to drive prioritization and execution decisions, maintaining executive visibility into progress, SLA, and livesite trends.

- Brought structure to ambiguity — coached teams on planning discipline, drove delivery predictability, and authored 175+ runbooks/playbooks in 5 months, eliminating 25,000+ stale incidents while sustaining 100% SLA across 20+ services.
- Influenced without authority across Security, Enterprise Architects, and Commercial-adjacent stakeholders to deliver a market-relevant automation capability on schedule.

Technical Program & Platform Lead — Customer Support Services

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Redmond, WA | Nov 2016 - May 2021

Led a 15-engineer team delivering enterprise-scale, platform, and vendor-integrated systems across multiple teams.

- Led cross-functional delivery of enterprise-scale platform and subscription-management programs across multiple engineering teams, managing dependencies, integration challenges, and risk across interconnected roadmaps.
- Partnered with engineering leadership and enterprise architects to influence design decisions, ensure cross-system alignment, and integrate cloud and vendor-integrated services with identity (ADFS/OKTA-class).
- Built program governance and reporting frameworks tracked via Jira/Confluence; ran steering-style reviews, status reporting, and stakeholder alignment across all organizational levels.
- Drove resolution of execution roadblocks and sequencing risks during large-scale migrations with zero-downtime cutovers, escalating clearly to maintain delivery predictability.
- Tailored communication from highly technical engineering discussions to leadership-level strategic narratives, managing expectations proactively across priorities and progress.

Delivery & Operations Lead — Azure Live Site

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Hyderabad, India | May 2012 - Nov 2016

Led 12 senior + 20 engineers delivering platform reliability programs at 99.95%+ SLA.

- Led 32 engineers delivering cross-team operational and platform programs across global data centers at 99.95%+ SLA, coaching ICs into technical leads.
- Ran disciplined planning, risk management, and change/release governance for patch and upgrade rollouts affecting millions of customer workloads with zero incidents.
- Built automation and reporting frameworks saving thousands of manual engineering hours and improving delivery rigor across distributed teams.
- Drove incident, problem, and change management (ITIL-aligned) and synthesized reliability data into executive reviews driving investment decisions.

Systems Analyst / Project Delivery Engineer

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Hammond, IN | Sep 2009 - Nov 2011

Infrastructure delivery and migration projects across enterprise environments.

- Coordinated infrastructure build, migration, and patch-deployment projects across RHEL/Windows environments with documented, repeatable execution.
- Tracked dependencies and deliverables across teams, ensuring predictable rollout of recurring operational projects.

SELECTED PROJECTS & CASE STUDIES

AI/LLM Product Delivery — Incident Automation — Led cross-functional delivery of an AI-powered automation capability (30-35% auto-resolution) from concept to scale; managed model evaluation frameworks and production trade-offs across latency, cost, reliability, and integration complexity.

Cross-Team Dependency & Integration Management — Mapped system, roadmap, and integration dependencies across interconnected engineering teams, proactively managing sequencing risks and scope/schedule trade-offs to maintain delivery predictability.

Executive Governance & Reporting — Established steering-style reviews and decision-ready written communications (status reports, executive briefs, decision memos, risk summaries) that drove clear C-suite decisions and accountable outcomes.

Data-Driven Prioritization Framework — Built reporting frameworks using Kusto (KQL) and Power BI to drive prioritization, surface risks early, and expose SLA and delivery trends to leadership.

Structure-from-Ambiguity Delivery Rigor — Authored 175+ runbooks/playbooks in 5 months, coached teams on planning discipline, eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents, and lifted operational efficiency 85% to 98%.

Enterprise-Scale Migration Programs — Delivered large-scale, vendor-integrated platform and subscription migrations with zero-downtime cutovers across multiple teams and roadmaps.

LEADERSHIP & COLLABORATION

- Led and mentored global teams of 15-32 engineers across the US and India, growing individual contributors into technical leads.
- Central escalation authority and SME for high-severity incidents, coordinating Security, Engineering, Product, and business teams under pressure.
- Ran 1:1s, performance reviews, onboarding, and targeted coaching/enablement plans; built psychologically safe, high-accountability culture.
- Synthesized incident and reliability data into executive reviews driving investment and process decisions.
- Early operationalizer of AI/automation in production support and operations; champion of continuous learning.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified IT Professional — Azure Infrastructure Solutions (70-533, 70-534)
- Microsoft AZ-900 — Azure Fundamentals
- Google Cloud Computing Foundations
- Google — Introduction to Generative AI
- TechMahindra AI White Belt

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Engineering, JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

PROFESSIONAL PHILOSOPHY

Bring structure to ambiguity, align people around clear goals and measurable outcomes, and

communicate with the clarity that lets executives decide quickly. I lead through influence, not authority — surfacing risk early, managing trade-offs honestly, and keeping delivery predictable from concept through scale.